



Tools mentioned in this article are purely from a 'study' perspective. Please remember, it is unlawful to hack or scan networks without consent and you can get prosecuted for doing so. The order in which these tools are mentioned is based on my own preference and it is not intended to undermine any tool's ratings or features.

each one targeted for a specific set of vulnerabilities. It comes as a Linux distribution, purely focusing on penetration-testing tools such as WebScarab for HTTP mapping, W3AF plug-ins for application-based attacks, and it also has tools to test browser-based exploits. It is amazing to note that the most recent version can find vulnerabilities that are usually not detected even by a few commercial software products.

Safe3 scanner: While the first two tools are good for static websites, for portals needing user ID and password, we need something that can deal with HTTP sessions and cookies. Safe3 scanner is a fantastic open source project, which has gained momentum and fame because it can handle almost all types of authentication, including NTLM. It contains a Web crawler (a spider like that of search engines) capable of ignoring duplicate page scans and yet detect client-side JavaScript vulnerabilities. Safe3 scans also detect the possibility of the latest AJAX-based attacks and even report vulnerable script libraries. It comes with a user-friendly GUI and is capable of creating nice management reports.

Websecrify: Though very similar to Samurai, Websecrify also brings application-level assessment into play. In case of a large Web farm where code is maintained by a team of developers, following standards can sometimes yield insecure code like passwords mentioned in

code, physical file paths in libraries, etc. Websecrify can traverse code and find such loopholes swiftly. A nice feature is that it allows you to create screenshots of the problem areas automatically, which helps in preparing audit reports. It is one of the very few platform-independent tools and also supports mobile coding, which is helping it get more popular in the cyber-security assessment world.

SQLmap: Unless I mention a tool to detect SQL-injection attacks, this article would not be complete. Though this is a very old 'first-generation' type of attack, many public websites still fail to fix it. SQLmap is capable of not just exploiting SQL-injection faults, but can also take over the database server. Since it focuses on a specific task, it works at great speed to fingerprint databases, find out the underlying file system and OS, and eventually fetch data from the server. It supports almost all well-known database engines, and can also perform password-guessing attacks. This tool can be combined with the other four tools mentioned above to scan a website aggressively.

A vulnerability assessment tool should include network scanning as well as website vulnerability exploitation. Open source software is prone to attacks too; hence, network administrators must know about the reputed scanners and use them in their daily tasks to make their infrastructure secure and stable. **END**

By: Prashant Phatak

The author has over 18 years of experience in the field of IT hardware, networking, Web technologies and IT security. He is MCSE and MCDBA certified, and is also an F5 load balancer expert. In the IT security world he is an ethical hacker and net-forensic specialist. Prashant runs his own firm called Valency Networks in India (<http://www.valencynetworks.com>), which provides consultancy services in IT security design, security audits, infrastructure technology and business process management. He can be reached at prashant@valencynetworks.com.

TOP GUN TECHNOLOGIES
The Best Network & Security Labs in India

Others Promise. We Deliver!

For A Highly Paid Career in India and Abroad

Special 10th Anniversary offer

CCNA	Rs. 8,000/-
CCNA Voice	Rs. 12,000/-
CCNA+CCNP-R&S	Rs. 25,000/-
CCNA+CCNP-Security	Rs. 35,000/-
CCNA+CCNP-SP	Rs. 35,000/-
CCNA+CCNP-Voice	Rs. 40,000/-

All Labs Conducted on CCIE Racks Free interoperability labs with Juniper Devices

Congrats to our Latest CCIEs

Mr Gokul Varma Kondekar	CCIE(R&S) #33920
Mr Sandesh Kumar Ramalingam	CCIE(R&S) #33745
Mr Bhupendra Singh	CCIE(Security) #33280
Mr Ajay Kumar Pal	CCIE(R&S) #33160
Mr. Shivaji Pule	CCIE # 33115
Mr. Ashish M	CCIE Security # 32880
Mr. Lipa Narghese	CCIE # 32871
Mr. Digvijay Pal	CCIE # 32830
Mr. Mateen Anis	CCIE Security # 32390

We also Offer Specialized CCIE Training
Special 15 days Bootcamp for CCIE (R&S): Rs.60,000/- and CCIE (Security): Rs.80,000/-

Training Advisor
AJAY PANDEY
BE, MS(USA), LLR, CCIE # 14792, (Security & R&S).
CISP, CISA, CISM, CCS, MCSE, SASP.

Lab Equipped with :
150 Cisco Routers (2811, 1841, 2621 XM, 3600, 2600, 2500, 1700, 700), 40 Cisco Catalyst Switches (5000, 3750, 3560, 3550, 3000, 2950, 2900), Frame-Relay / ISDN, 12 Firewalls: SonicWall, Watchguard, Cisco PIX 515 E (IIR), ASA 5510, PIX 501, 3005 VPN concentrator, 4240, 4210 IPS sensor, Nokia IP 330, Check Point, CiscoWAP/ NICs, Cisco Call Manager MCS 7825, Cisco IP Phones 7960, 7961.

Local Accommodation Available
We have Graduated over 100 CCIEs.

BANGALORE
Visit our Website :
www.topguntechnologies.com
info@topguntechnologies.com
tgtechno@gmail.com
SMS 080- 65616600
080-23528500

If you find a better Institute to do any of these courses, Join it !

www.LinuxForU.com | LINUX FOR YOU | FEBRUARY 2012 | 91